

Crochet Cocoon / Fairy house (US terms)



Materials:

Drops Eskimo colour 1 - 3 balls
Drops Eskimo colour 2 - 3 balls
5 mm crochet needle
Old towels
Washing machine and soft soap or dish soap
(normal soap is too soft)

Abbreviations:

sc = single crochet
dcdec = decrease 2 dc
dcinc = 2 dc in 1 stitch
slst = slip stitch
ch = chain
dc = double crochet
st = stitch

Finished size: about 45 cm high and 30 cm wide (kitten size), using a 5 mm needle.
To make a bigger cocoon, use 2 strands of yarn and a bigger needle (about 9 mm).

This pattern is very suited as a fairy house for small dolls or you can use it as a basket.
Because of the side opening its ideal to put in a closet or onto a shelf.

The cocoon will be crocheted and put in the washing machine to felt. By felting it the cocoon will become solid, so don't worry if it collapses before felting!

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If you have any questions join the Facebook group: Hanneke's Designs Support Group, or send a message to my shop or hannekesdesigns@gmail.com

Cocoon:

Start with colour 1.

Rnd 1: ch 4, slst in the 1st st

Rnd 2: ch 2, 6 dc in the ring, slst in 1st st (6)

Rnd 3-4: [2 rounds] ch 2, dc in each st, slst in 1st st (6)

Rnd 5: ch 2, (2 dc, dcinc) [2x] slst in 1st st (8)

Rnd 6-8: [3 rounds] ch 2, dc in each st, slst in 1st st (8)

Rnd 9: ch 2, (3 dc, dcinc) [2x] slst in 1st st (10)

Rnd 10-12: [3 rounds] ch 2, dc in each st, slst in 1st st (10)

Rnd 13: ch 2, (4 dc, dcinc) [2x] slst in 1st st (12)

Rnd 14: ch 2, dc in each st, slst in 1st st (12)

Rnd 15: ch 2, (2 dc, dcinc) [4x] slst in 1st st (16)

Rnd 16: ch 2, dc in each st, slst in 1st st (16)

Rnd 17: ch 2, (3 dc, dcinc) [4x] slst in 1st st (20)

Rnd 18: ch 2, (4 dc, dcinc) [4x] slst in 1st st (24)

Rnd 19: ch 2, (3 dc, dcinc) [6x] slst in 1st st (30)

Rnd 20: ch 2, (4 dc, dcinc) [6x] slst in 1st st (36)

Rnd 21: ch 2, (2 dc, dcinc) [12x] slst in 1st st (48)

Rnd 22: ch 2, (3 dc, dcinc) [12x] slst in 1st st (60)

Rnd 23: ch 2, (4 dc, dcinc) [12x] slst in 1st st (72)

Rnd 24: ch 2, (5 dc, dcinc) [12x] slst in 1st st (84)

Rnd 25: ch 2, (6 dc, dcinc) [12x] slst in 1st st (96)

Rnd 26: ch 2, (7 dc, dcinc) [10x], 7 dc, ch 2, turn (97)

Rnd 27: dcdec [2x], 4 dc, dcinc, (8 dc, dcinc) [9x], 3 dc, dcdec [2x] ch 2, turn (103)

Rnd 28: dcdec [2x], 95 dc, dcdec [2x], ch 2, turn (99)

Rnd 29-31: [3 rounds] dc in each st, ch 2, turn (99)

Change colour. Make the last ch 2 using the new colour. Repeat the last round if you want the cocoon to be higher (This also makes the hole bigger, so there is a bigger chance of the hole collapsing).

Rnd 32-33: [2 rounds] dc in each st, ch 2, turn (99)

Rnd 34: 99 dc, ch 9, slst in the first st (108)

Rnd 35-36: [2 rounds] ch 2, dc in each st, slst in 1st st (108)

Rnd 37: ch 2, (7 dc, dcdec) [12x] (96)

Rnd 38: ch 2, (6 dc, dcdec) [12x] (84)

Rnd 39: ch 2, (5 dc, dcdec) [12x] (72)

Rnd 40: ch 2, (4 dc, dcdec) [12x] (60)

Rnd 41: ch 2, (3 dc, dcdec) [12x] (48)

Rnd 42: ch 2, (2 dc, dcdec) [12x] (36)

Rnd 43: ch 2, (1 dc, dcdec) [12x] (24)

Rnd 44: ch 2, (dc, dcdec) [12x] (12)

Fasten off. Wave the yarn through the front loop of each remaining stitch, from front to back. Pull the yarn tight to close the hole and secure the end.

The cocoon is about 65 cm high (bottom to point) and 40 cm wide.



Reinforce the hole:

Reinforce the hole by crocheting a round of sc around the hole. This will be almost invisible if you do this before felting, using the same yarn.

If you want more detail, felt the cocoon first and use a thinner thread (like drops nepal) and a smaller needle (3 mm) to crochet the border after felting.

Start in the bottom corner using a long thread. Crochet on top of the starting thread, to make the border more firm.

Start by making an sc in the corner between the rounds and the chain. Sc in each ch, sc in the corner, divide 16 sc over the side of the hole. Sc in the corner, sc in each skipped st, sc in the corner, 16 sc divided over the side. If the sides turn out to be to wobbly, make more or less sc on the sides.



Felting:

Now for the exciting part, the felting!

Every washing machine is different, so make sure to keep an eye. You can always stop a washing program sooner!

If you doubt about the temperature, use a washing program of 40 degrees and felt it twice, if needed.

Make sure all threads are fastened off. You can make a knot in the point of the cocoon (this is still possible after felting).

Put the cocoon in the washing machine together with a few tennis balls (optional) and a bit of soft soap or dish soap.

The washing program I used was a 60°C cotton program that takes 2,5 hours. Halfway through I was happy with the result and turned it off. Then I put the washing machine on a gentle spin cycle to remove most of the water.

Check every 20 minutes or so to see if the cocoon has shrunk to your preferable size yet and whether the stitches are still visible. The stitches should be (nearly) invisible and it should look like a piece of felt.



Fill the cocoon with towels and stretch and pull it in the right shape. Make sure there are no lumps because they could stay in there after drying. If you would like something like a curl in the tip, you should shape that now.

When the cocoon has dried you can decorate it any way you want! Mine got decorated with embroidery but you could also use things like crochet appliques.

I used the chain stitch, stem stitch and french knot and used some of my scheepjes sweet treat leftovers. Have fun and be original, nothing is right or wrong!

If your opening starts to collapse over time, you could choose to make an extra round of sc around the hole, like you did before. You could crochet on top of iron wire to make it extra firm. Make sure the ends aren't sticking out!

Is your cat sitting on top of the cocoon instead of in it? You could firmly attach a big thread inside the tip of the cocoon and hang it.



This pattern has not been tested as much because its a free pattern. This means its possible there are some flaws. If something isn't clear or you find a flaw, let me know!

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